Richard Larocque

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SKILLS

Expert in Ruby, Go; worked in C, C++, Java, Python, TypeScript
Deep expertise in MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch
Experienced building scalable distributed systems
Kafka, Kubernetes, Temporal, observability tooling (OpenTelemetry)
Deep understanding of Linux
Bilingual (English and French)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Distinguished Engineer May 2015 — Present
Outreach.io

- First engineering hire; scaled the platform from Series A to Unicorn
- Architected and implemented the first search, governance, and authentication systems
- Addressed early scaling bottlenecks in Elasticsearch, CouchDB, MySQL, and RabbitMQ
- Wrote widely-read canonical reference articles on internal architecture
- Implemented observability systems that improved debugging practices across all teams
- Helped establish standard service patterns during migration to Go and Kubernetes
- Optimized API-to-ActiveRecord translation, enabling clean API-based service decomposition
- Built a durable, ordered, outbox CDC system on top of Rails to enable data decomposition
- Architected and prototyped a scalable backend for a real-time activity feed
- Championed AI platform adoption; helped establish Python service patterns

Software Engineer August 2011 — August 2014 (Chrome)
Google Inc., Seattle, WA August 2014 — April 2015 (Infrastructure)

- Helped to maintain and improve Chrome's Sync feature (C++)
- Learned to work on software that sees over 100 commits per day
- Devised a sequence CRDT for encoding ordered lists in a NoSQL data store
- Built a pipeline to transform server logs into actionable performance metrics (Java)

Design Engineer May 2009 — July 2011 (full-time)
Avvasi Inc., Waterloo, ON September 2008 — December 2008 (intern)

- Implemented code to analyze GTP traffic in a live network
- Designed a product licensing solution based on digital signatures
- Improved inter-thread messaging performance with a set of lockless queues
- Helped the company grow from 10 to 50 employees

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Software Engineering Graduated in 2009
University of Waterloo
Waterloo, Ontario, Canada
Co-op placements: NVIDIA, Wind River, Netsweeper, Environment Canada

OTHER ACTIVITIES

- See also: `https://github.com/richardlarocque`
- Completed 15 marathons, with a personal best of 3:11
- Completed an Ironman Triathlon in 2016